

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1167

By Capley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of William Samuel "W.S." Howard, Jr., and Mary Elizabeth "Tootsie" Howard of Clifton.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should honor the memory of those esteemed individuals whose lives of service and dedication left an indelible mark upon their communities and the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, two such individuals are William Samuel "W.S." Howard, Jr., and Mary Elizabeth "Tootsie" Howard, who distinguished themselves as citizens of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity throughout their lives; and

WHEREAS, W.S. Howard was born on June 17, 1914, in Clifton, to William Samuel Howard, Sr., and Mary Pauline Tucker Howard; from an early age, he learned the value of diligence and perseverance while working in his family's grocery store and on Tucker Farms in Decatur County; and

WHEREAS, a 1932 graduate of Frank Hughes School, Mr. Howard played basketball in school and second base on Clifton's independent baseball team; he later worked at Milky Way Farm in Giles County before returning to Clifton to devote himself to the family business and to the community he loved; and

WHEREAS, in the spring of 1934, W.S. Howard met "Tootsie" Crofts of Savannah, the daughter of Gaines and Amy Porter Crofts; a talented and accomplished young woman who had been crowned Miss Savannah, she shared his deep appreciation for family, community, and civic life; and

WHEREAS, W.S. Howard and Tootsie Crofts were united in marriage on June 17, 1935, beginning a partnership that would endure for decades and contribute greatly to the civic and social life of the Clifton community; and

WHEREAS, together, Mr. and Mrs. Howard raised three sons, Bill, Gene, and Don, and remained active members of the Methodist Church in Clifton while participating in many civic and community activities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Howard carried forward the family tradition of service and enterprise when he and his wife purchased Howard's Grocery and continued to operate the longtime Main Street establishment until his retirement in 1972; he further served the community as a member of the Masonic Lodge, a director of Peoples Bank, and a city commissioner for Clifton; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Howard was actively involved in a number of civic and community organizations, including the Eastern Star and the Shiloh Chapter of the United Daughters of the Confederacy, and she was also known for her artistic talent, sharing many beautiful paintings with family and friends; and

WHEREAS, W.S. Howard passed away in October 1973 at the age of fifty-nine, and Tootsie Howard continued to embody the values they shared until her passing in November 2014 at the age of ninety-four, leaving behind a legacy that continues to inspire those who knew them; and

WHEREAS, the lives of W.S. and Tootsie Howard were marked by dedication, integrity, and steadfast commitment to the principles they held dear; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of William Samuel "W.S." Howard, Jr., and Mary Elizabeth "Tootsie" Howard of Clifton, reflecting with gratitude upon their lives of service and extending our deepest respect to their family and all those who continue to cherish their memory.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.